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Booz | Allen | Hamilton

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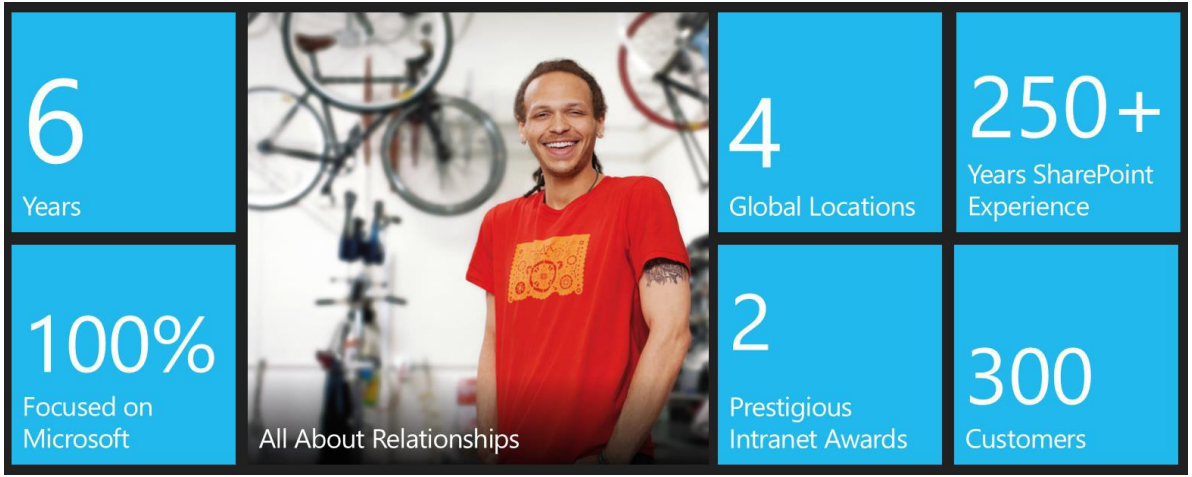


# Booz | Allen | Hamilton

## Findings Document

August 1, 2014

# Findings Document Content

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- Project Overview
- Key Findings
- Workshop Activities
  - Intranet Vision Statement
  - Define User Groups
  - Task Analysis
  - Parent Categories
  - Sketching
  - Use Case Creation
- Personas
- Task Analysis
- Design Expo
- Recommendations
  - Site Map
  - Wireframes
- Next Steps
- Appendix

# Project Overview

# Project Overview and Goal

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This document is a consolidation of all findings from the initial engage workshops. It covers the pain-points of the current intranet and the high level requirements for the architecture and redesign of an improve intranet to be develop on the SharePoint 2013 platform.

Booz Allen Hamilton (BAH) has engaged BrightStarr to envision and build a SharePoint Intranet to replace their existing platform, which does not promote a rich and complete user experience. We conducted several workshops with BAH and connected with Intranet Stakeholders and project sponsors to understand their needs, as well as formulate ideas around shaping a user centric SharePoint Intranet.

The BAH team defined some success criteria in response to our interviews and exercises, which are listed below. This criteria will focus our design efforts, guide our decisions and ensure the team is working towards the same goal.

# Roles & Functions

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**Narrative:**
Gauge of Staff Counts in the organization. An 'x' indicator is shown where we believe Role performs subject action.

| | | Internal Levels & Functional Areas | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Level** | **Count** | **Career Manager** | **Job Manager** | **Subject Matter Expert** | **Contributor/ Researcher** | **Communicator** |
| Partner | | x | | | | x |
| Vice President | | x | | | | x |
| Principal | | x | x | x | | x |
| Senior Associate | | x | x | x | x | x |
| Lead Associate | | x | x | x | x | x |
| Associate | | x | x | x | x | x |
| Senior Consultant | | | | | x | |
| Consultant | | | | | x | |
| AP | | | | | x | x |
| **Total** | **23,786** | | | | | |

****Note:** Total staff excludes contractor count who may have intranet access.
****Source:** Count levels derived from HRIS Systems. Functions from workshop and interview discussions.

# Roles & Functions Descriptions

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| Perspective | Description |
|---|---|
| Career Manager | Manages people and their careers in the firm |
| Job Manager | Manages projects, and people delivering on the project. May be at client site, may be an internal project |
| Subject Matter Expert | Someone with deep expertise who provides input, writing contributions (proposals/white papers), and hands on solutions to the issues (client or internal) |
| Contributor/ Researcher | A staff person who may not have the deep expertise, but will find it via other people or content research in order to inform people, teams, or projects |
| Communicator | We have two types of communicators - leadership who communicate the course of the firm, business and teams. And then those that communicate more laterally with people, teams, or projects |

# Key Findings

# Key Findings

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**Accessibility**

Searchability

User Profile

Content

Social

Governance

Integration

While on site reviewing of the existing intranet, we discovered that BAH has around 23,000 globally distributed employees. A **small minority** of this workforce is Internal Professionals (IP) that are servicing the internal needs of BAH. This employee subset is typically in a BAH office or utilizing BAH equipment with ease of access to remaining connected with what is happening throughout the enterprise.

The **large majority** of the workforce is Client Facing professionals that are servicing the needs of BAH clients. This workforce is traditionally geographically dispersed, with limited means of accessing the BAH 'Hello' Intranet. Client Facing professionals are also inundated with pressures of satisfying their unique client requirements as well as being expected to meet BAH corporate requirements.

**Some hurdles** Client Facing professionals face are the inability to use client provided devices when connecting to the BAH intranet and the inability to utilize personal mobile devices to access a mobile rich intranet. This often translates to Client Facing professionals with having to remain connected during their personal time.

The redesigned intranet will strive to provide a uniform experience across Mobile, Tablet, and Desktop devices with an active connection. Security will be at the forefront of implementation decisions.

# Key Findings

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Accessibility

**Searchability**

User Profile

Content

Social

Governance

Integration

Attendees expressed a strong focus on search, informing us that most users search to locate digital content. A **Mission Critical** success factor is ability to find and retrieve relevant information quickly using an improved search experience. The existing search function returns an overwhelming amount of results, often non-relevant, causing user frustration, Advanced filters can aid in minimizing the search volume; however, users express challenges in understanding what the filters are.

An Information Architecture (IA) initiative is already underway, and BrightStarr will leverage these efforts and provide our suggestions and recommendations on this initiative. Our end goal for this focus area is to design and architect SharePoint solution with the search experience as a major component for success.

BrightStarr understands and recognizes the importance of search for BAH. The new BAH intranet will be designed and architected in a manner to drive a better search experience with more contextually relevant results and simple controls to reduce a large result set to a manageable number.

# Key Findings

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Accessibility

Searchability

**User Profile**

Content

Social

Governance

Integration

In the current system, the User Profile is **Mission Critical** to the day-to-day operations. This is a central page for the subject user, and critical to Internal BAH Staff looking for people for personal or professional reasons. For example, the User Profile is where a Job Manager might search for a specific employee who can fill a specific role on a project. In order to discover this employee, the manager needs to search by specific job criteria or skills to find resources and review their employee profile.

Users expressed the need to personalize their intranet in order to display the content they need. Some of the challenges are in providing users with a personalized experience reside in creating the right balance between employee customization and the business need to provide required content for business operations.

BrighStarr's understands the importance of the user profile and will design a solution that finds the right balance between the user's need for a personalized experience and the business need for required information.

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# Workshop Activities

Intranet Vision Statement

Content Analysis

Task Analysis

Business Value

Design Studio

Scenarios / Personas

IA & Taxonomy

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# Intranet Vision Statement

# Workshop Process

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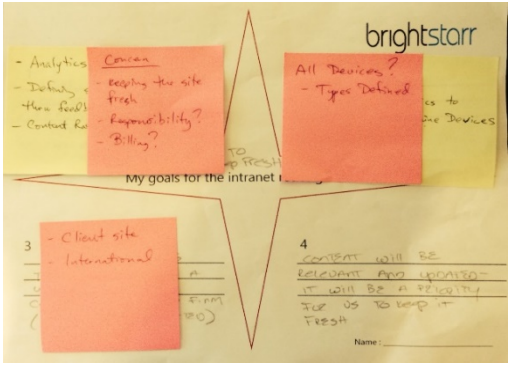


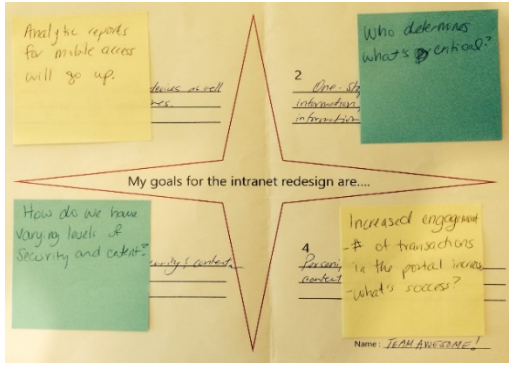


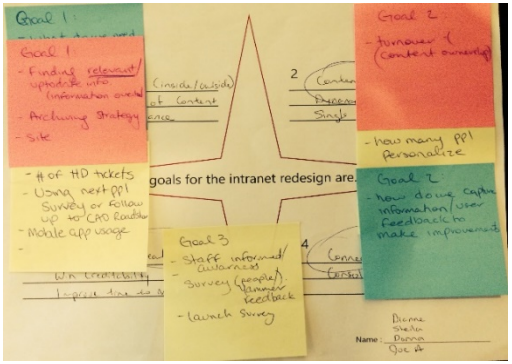


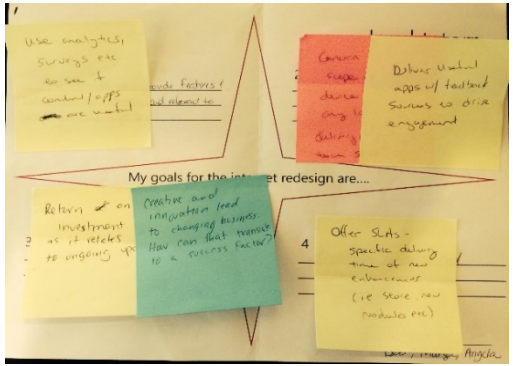


The goal of this workshop was to solicit ideas through discussion, forming a unified vision for the redesign of the intranet.

Each attendee was given a worksheet and asked to identify their goals for the intranet redesign.

We then discussed as a group, using colored sticky notes to call out ideas, questions and concerns about the identified goals.

# Content Analysis

# SWOT

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The content analysis highlighted many strengths, weakness, opportunities and threats.

## Strength

- Lots of contributors to curate and provide content
- Ongoing parallel efforts by BAH in creating an improve IA
- Yammer is popular and use daily by employees

## Weakness

- Terabytes of data with no content strategy
- No content governance - content is outdated and irrelevant
- Confusion from the multiple types of sites (team, publishing, enterprise, firm facing, functional communities)

## Opportunity

- Content personalization
- Delivery of information in rich media format
- Create a unified data farm to house all content
- Comprehensive governance plan
- Branding exercise

## Threats

- Loss of credibility from users
- Usage drop off from frustration
- Performance issues
- Content is called from multiple resources
- Members are using communities for target marketing

# Content Focus Areas

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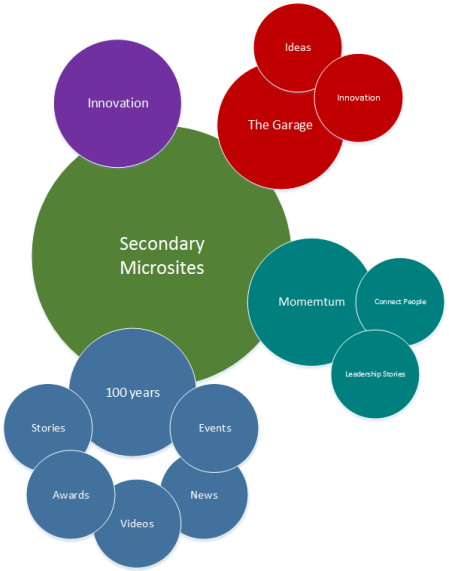


This diagram echoes the key focal points for content that will be consider in the first release of the redesign.

BAH has a number of secondary sites with content that we think should be migrated to the intranet overtime.

- 100 Years
- Innovation
- The Garage
- Momentum

# Task Analysis

# Workshop Process

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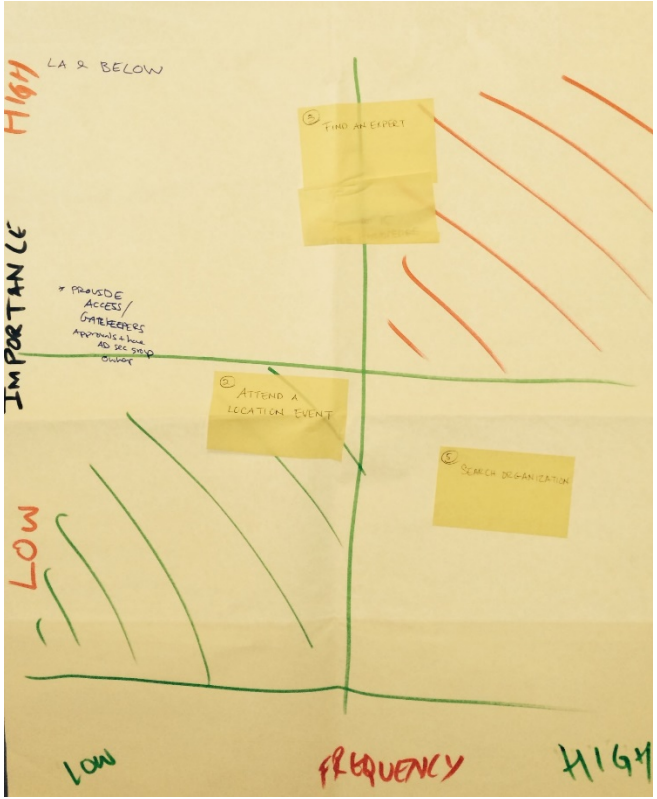
During this workshop, users were asked to identify the responsibilities of the targeted user types for the intranet redesign. We then instructed them to plot on a graph the level importance and frequency for the outlined tasks. This allowed BrightStarr to get a deeper understanding of the roles, goals and cognitive style of these users within the system.

We captured data about the:

- Partners
- Senior Associates
- Lead Associates
- Consultants – location base
- Admin Professionals
- SCIF
- Internal Professionals
- Career Managers
- Proposal Managers
- Job Mangers
- Client Facing



# Workshop Output

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| | Task / Concern | Importance | | | Frequency | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Low | Medium | High | Low | Medium | High |
| **Principals - Partners** | Business Intelligence<br>• Earnings<br>• Pipeline<br>• Promotions<br>• Growth based metrics | | | ✓ | | | ✓ |
| | Monthly meetings agenda | | | ✓ | ✓ | | |
| | Stakeholder Events | | ✓ | ✓ | | ✓ | ✓ |
| | Awards & Recognition<br>• New business<br>• Industry recognition | ✓ | | ✓ | ✓ | | ✓ |
| | Infrastructure Reports | | ✓ | | | ✓ | |

# Workshop Output

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| | Task / Concern | Importance | | | Frequency | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Low | Medium | High | Low | Medium | High |
| **Client Facing** | Prepare staff for new billable work when contract ends | | | ✓ | ✓ | | |
| | Create certification and accreditation | | | ✓ | | ✓ | |
| | Create monthly status reports (MSR) | | | ✓ | | ✓ | |
| | Tracking contracts, burn rates and scope of work | | ✓ | | | | ✓ |
| | Create a “QUAL” | | ✓ | | | ✓ | |

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# Scenarios / Personas

# Workshop Process

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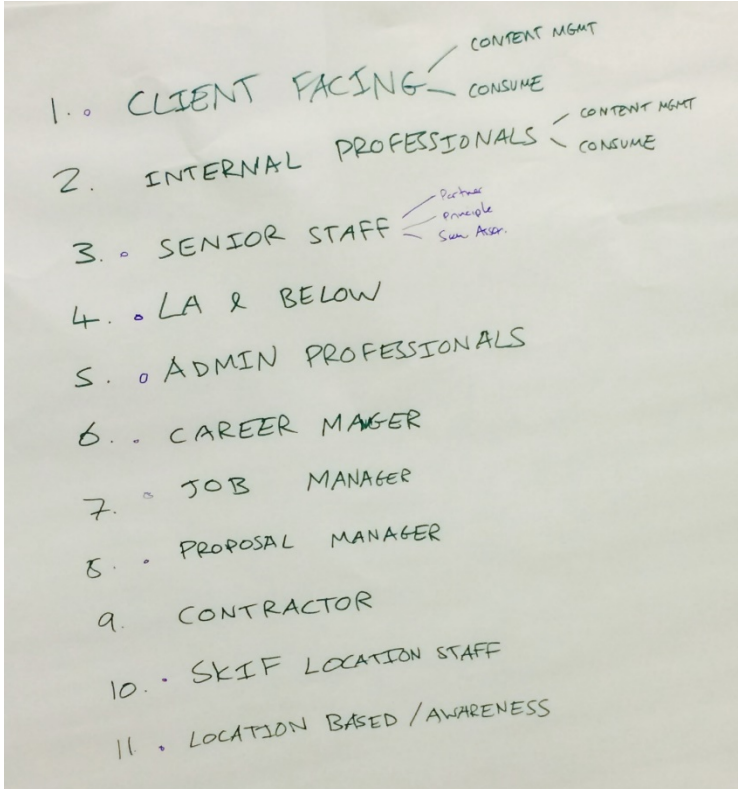
Personas are fictional characters created to represent the different user types within a targeted demographic, attitude and/or behavior set that might use a site, or product in a similar way.

The personas were prepared from the outcome of the User Profile and Scenario workshop sessions. We use the personas to ensure that we're keeping the users in mind throughout the project. So, when we recommend a feature or a design, we cross check it with the personas to ensure it would be useful and/or desirable to the identified personas.

The primary focus was on the needs of the Lead Associates and lower as success was being measured on address their needs.



# Elizabeth

## Lead Associate

*"The intranet helps to form my impression of the company as a whole, the clearer it is the better impression I'll have"*

**Software**
Windows 7/8
IE10, Firefox, Safari, Chrome

**Hardware**
Laptop, Mobile Phone, Tablet

*"I'm trying to manage my clients, connect with peers and advance in my functional discipline"*

## Back Story

Being a Booz Allen Hamilton employee for over 4 years, I'm really dedicated to meeting the needs of my client by providing for them the best possible service. I am also eager to improve my skillsets which would assist in advancing my career. To accomplish this I would need to be well connect and to keep abreast of the constant changes in the enterprise.

## Motivations

I am seeking new challenges and secretly admire the role of the senior leaders. It would be exciting to learn from those around me, especially those with similar responsibilities who have been in the company longer than me. I 'm eager to learn fast so I can make an impact and better manage my clients. Although my team is friendly and easily approachable, it would also be very helpful if I could get the information I need about the company and career paths on my own. This will help to build self-assurance, showcase my leadership potential, and better prepare me for the next step in my career.

## Domain Expertise

Low — High

## SharePoint Comfort

Low — High

**User Groups**
Job Managers
Career Managers
Proposal Mangers
Consulting
SCIF - location base

## Goals

- To be successful in my role and to be recognized for my efforts
- Secure my job and explore opportunities for promotions
- Find templates, tools, resources for my client delivery
- Stay up-to-date with company events

## Frustrations

- Navigation and search is painful. I am unable to find fresh and relevant content easily
- I don't have access to everything, it's frustrating not being able to connect to the intranet at all times and on any device

## Expectations

- Knowledge and resource library to assist obtain important documentation
- Relevant and up-to-date content that's not tailored to my interest
- User dashboard to collaborate, share and communicate with other employees

*"Communication is key when I am constantly remote."*

# Joel

## Location Based Consultant

*"I need information quickly and on the go"*

**Software**
Windows 7/8
IE10, Chrome

**Hardware**
Laptop, Mobile Phone, Tablet

## Back Story

I have been location base with Booz Allen for almost 2 years. I am constantly on the road or in a governments offices. I sometimes have to surrender my laptop due to security rules at the client which hampers my ability to connect with Booz Allen. I don't have time to sift through tons of emails or documents and need a way to see only what is important to me. Because I am always on the go, connecting to Booz Allen on my mobile/tablet device is crucial.

## Motivations

There are so many different applications I need to access, for example when I book travel, review my benefits or access training. I'd like a consistent way to get to all these places. Right now I use bookmarks, or my browser history to get to the places I use regularly. I'd be motivated to visit the intranet regularly if it was a 'one stop' shop, if I knew I could get to all the places I needed from one homepage.

## Domain Expertise

Low — High

## SharePoint Comfort

Low — High

**User Groups**
Associates
Client Facing
SCIF - location base

## Goals

- I only want to see communication relevant to me and my group
- I want real-time 2-way communication with the enterprise

## Frustrations

- Information overload! I loose many hours of productivity because I am unable to find irrelevant information
- There is limited support for field personnel
- Searching and finding information is inconclusive

## Expectations

- A modern and efficient application
- Location based data that would be helpful
- Easily view information that is important to me
- Push content (news, outages, alerts)
- Collaboration

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# Business Value

# Workshop Process: MoSCoW Activity

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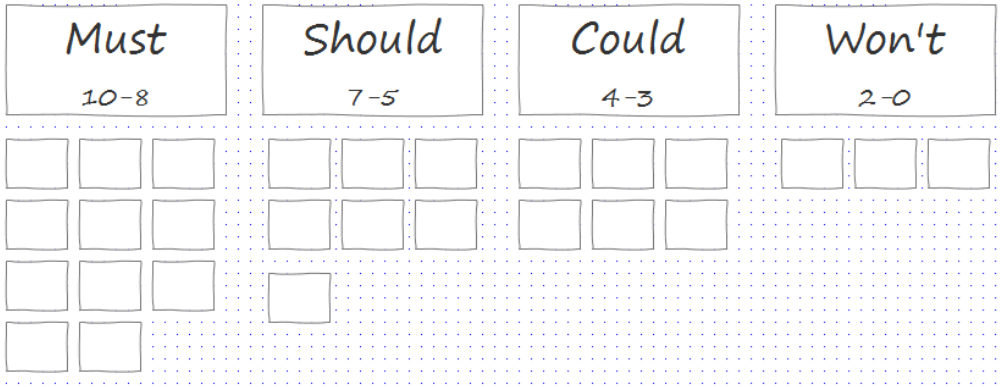
MoSCoW is one of the most important activities during the first workshop. For all of the tasks that were captured, we focused on a core set of tasks based on the different user groups and then went through the process of prioritization.

- Must: A requirement that must be fulfilled in the final solution.
- Should: A requirement that should be included in the solution if possible.
- Could: A requirement that is possibly wanted, but not necessary
- Won't: A requirement that stakeholders have agreed will not be implemented in this version of the solution.

The prioritization is essential to deliver the greatest and most immediate business benefits objectives for the desired feature.



# Workshop Output

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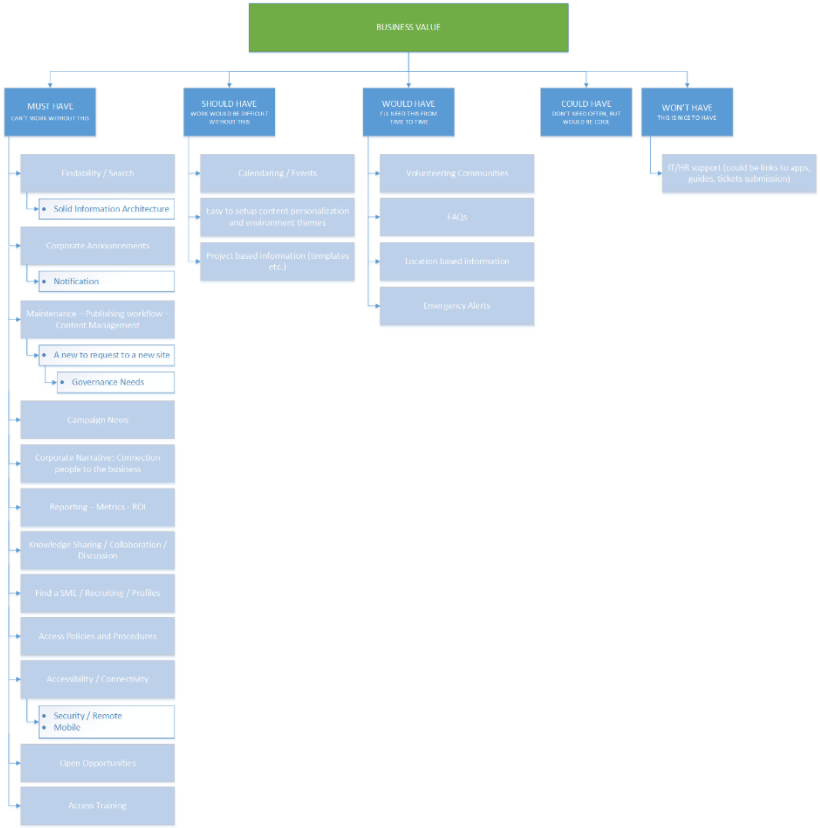

# Design Studio

# Workshop Process

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The goal of this Gametorming activity was to explore the creative thinking of the BAH workshop attendees. Those who took part were divided in groups, and tasked with sketching concepts of how the homepage redesign should look on a mobile, and a desktop device.

We encouraged the teams to focus on the “Must Have, Should Have, Would Have, Could Have, and Won’t Have” features that were defined in the MoSCoW workshop.

The outcome provided insight to some of BAH visual and aesthetic expectations. The Brightstarr team was very excited to discover that BAH had a similar focus creativity and were forward thinking in their approach.

# Mobile Sketches 1 & 2

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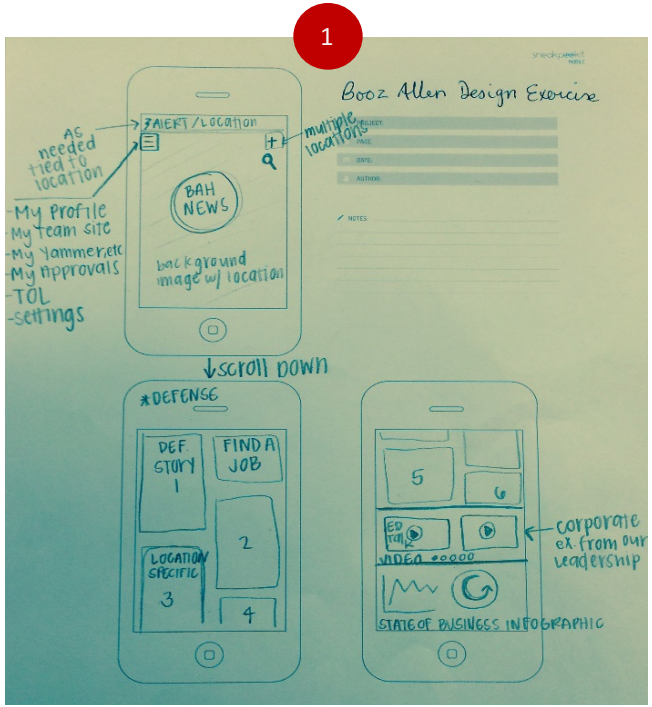
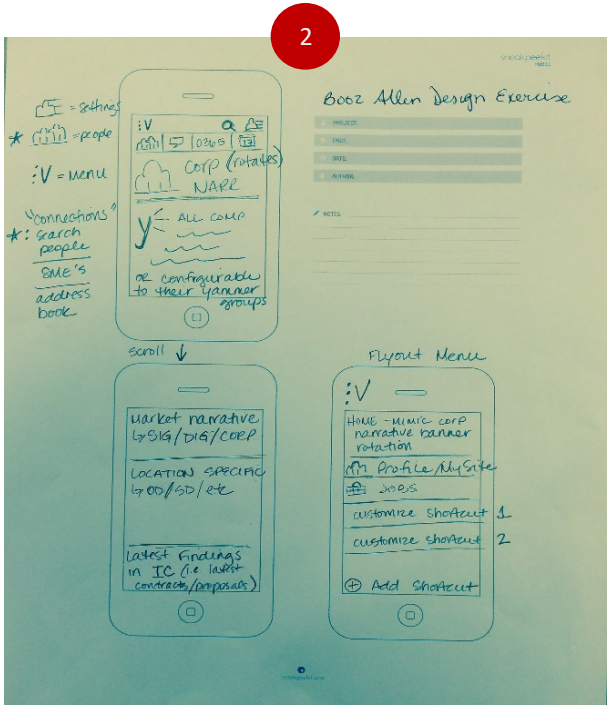
The team members from the mobile design concepts below were later grouped to create the "Sketch 1 – Desktop". Each mobile containers is representative of the user scrolling downward.




1. This design showcased a very modern and minimalistic interface with a large hero image influence by the "Weather Channel" app. It reflects content modules that address the different user types and include iconography for searching and navigating.

2. Although this default view was a little busier than concept 1, it does a great job at demonstrating important mobile design conventions (staking of content and use of icons).

# Desktop Sketch 1

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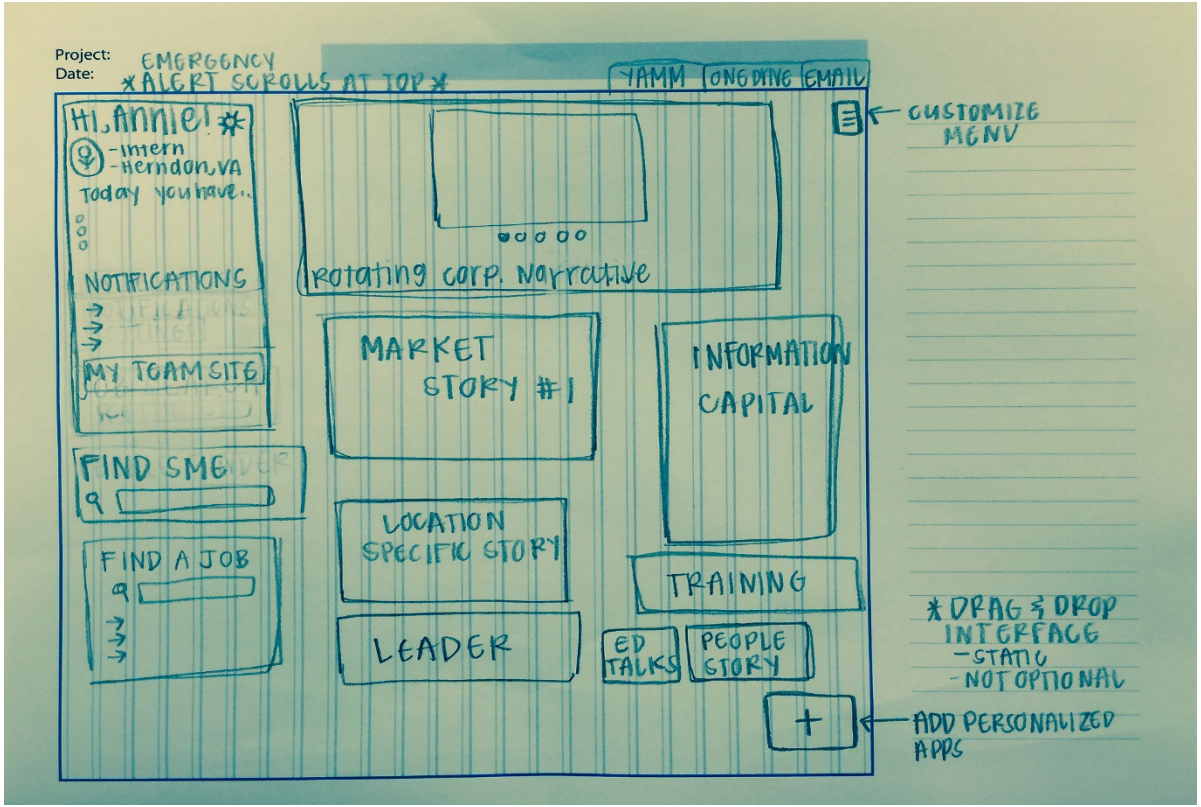


This desktop concept represents the amalgamation of the previous slide - "Mobile Sketches 1 & 2"

**Pros**

- Contains content blocks that speaks to the needs of different users and their cognitive styles.
- Layout demonstrates an understanding of design conventions and the future of website aesthetics
    - Utility links located in the eyebrow of the page
    - Single control to "show/hide" navigational elements

**Cons**

- Site should have only one search form where the user can preselect a search topic.

# Mobile Sketches 3, 4 & 5

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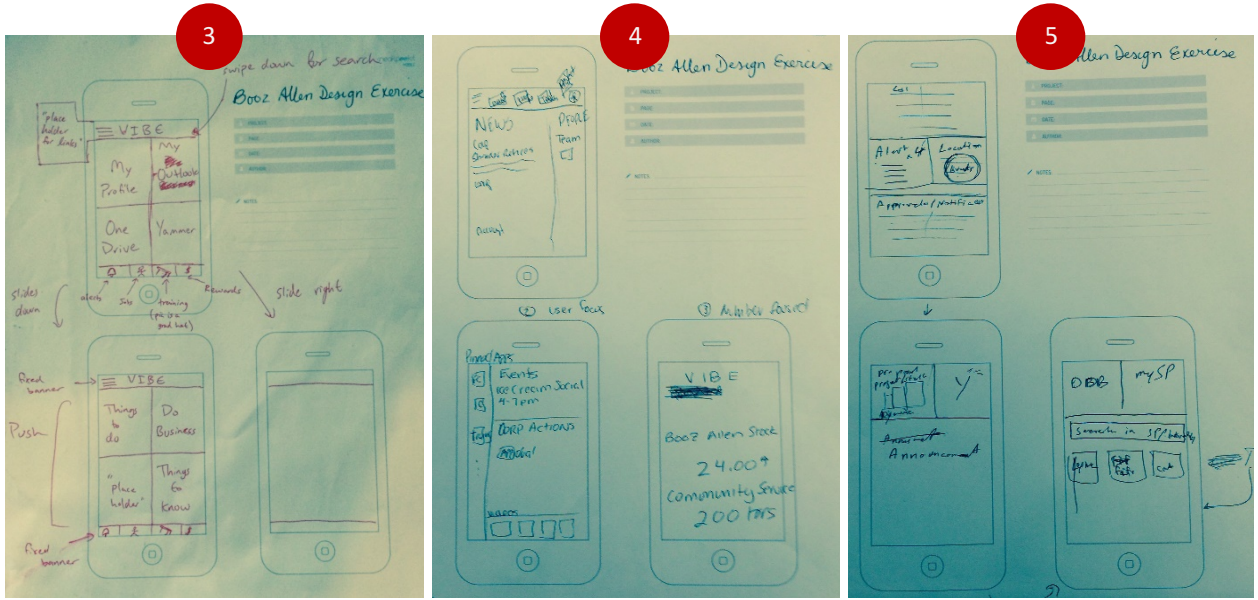
The team members from the mobile design concepts below were later grouped to create the "Desktop Sketch 2".




3. This design reflects a modern aesthetic while making full use of touch interface gestures to "show/hide" key functionality. It exhibits Microsoft's Flat Magazine UX design.

4. A simple, clean concept that shows a clever use of iconography and page real estate.

5. This concept also exhibits the "Flat Magazine UX". This allows for large visual content blocks that can be easily personalize.

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# IA / Taxonomy

# Workshop Process

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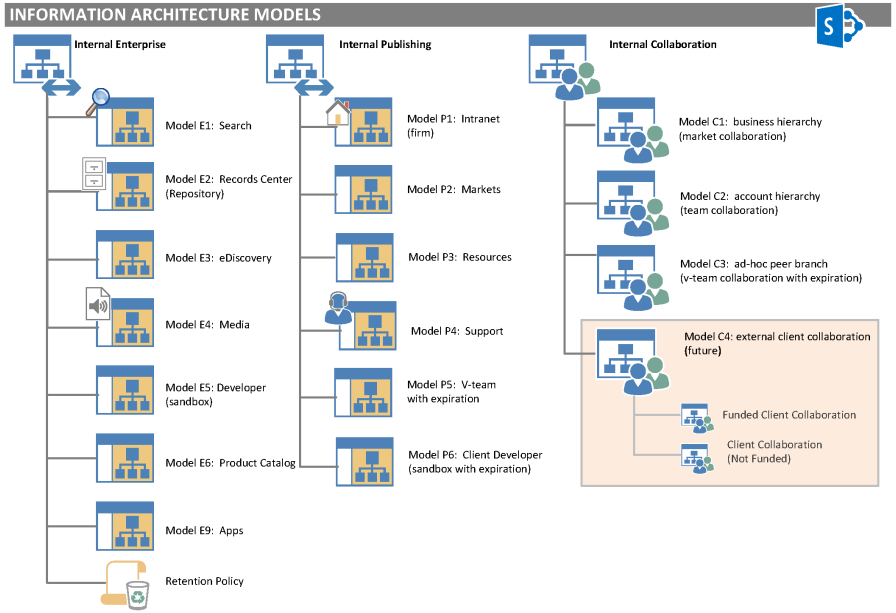


**REFERENCE**
Plan sites and site collections in SharePoint 2013 - Model of an intranet:
http://technet.microsoft.com/en-us/library/cc263267.aspx

The work already done by BAH prior to Brightstarr's engagements will go a long way in fast tracking the restructuring of their current taxonomy.

We conducted high level discussions around:

- Content types
- Data migration to SharePoint
- Information tagging which would help in developing a robust folksonomy
- BAH career tracks
- Content governance
- Systems integration
- Maintaining functionality within user profiles
- Next generation search and discovery using "Microsoft Delve and Office Graph"

# Hello Directory Structure

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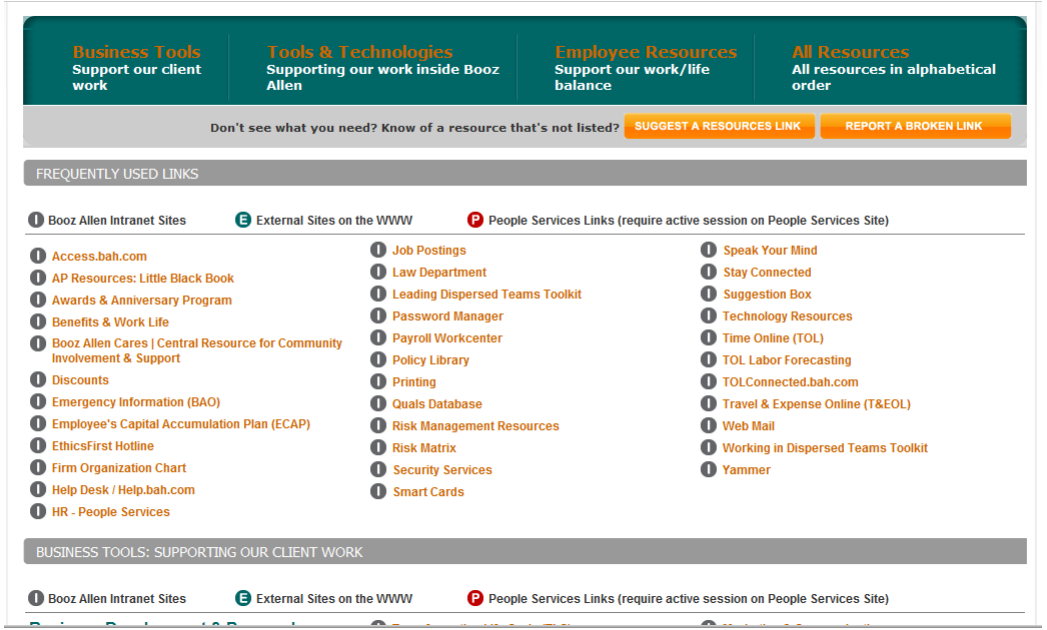


The “All Resources” page has over 400 links. This section is popular with users for navigating due to a poorly functioning search engine.

The links are of 3 types of content:

- Booz Allen Intranet Sites
- External Sites on the WWW
- People Services Links

Content is bucked as:

- Frequently Used Links
- Business Tools: Supporting Our Client Work
- Tools & Technologies: Supporting Our Work Inside Booz Allen
- Employees Resources: Supporting Our Work/Life Balance

# Hello Taxonomy

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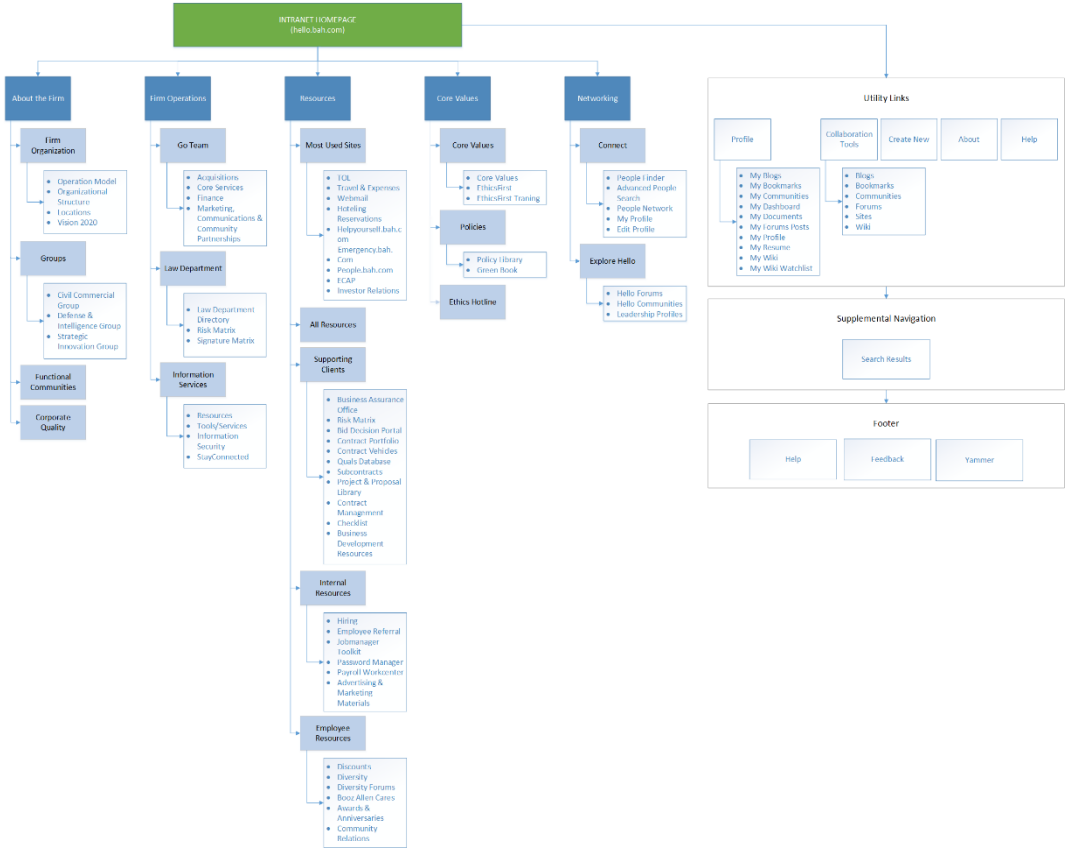

# Next Steps